

SOUTH EASTERN KENYA UNIVERSITY

SCHOOL OF EDUCATION

DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATIONAL COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY

TEACHING PRACTICUM I REPORT SUBMITTED TO THE SCHOOL OF EDUCATION IN PARTIAL FULFILMENT OF THE REQUIREMENTS FOR THE AWARD OF THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF EDUCATION OF SOUTH EASTERN KENYA UNIVERSITY

NAME: CHARLES MAKORI NYAMAO

REGISTRATION NUMBER: E122/1429/2024

PRACTICUM SCHOOL: NYABIMWA MIXED SECONDARY SCHOOL

PRACTICUM PERIOD: 11TH MAY 2026 TO 6TH JULY 2026

DATE OF SUBMISSION: _____

DECLARATION

I, Charles Makori Nyamao, declare that this teaching practicum report is a true reflection of my experiences, observations, and activities conducted during my 30 days practicum at Nyabimwa Mixed Secondary School.

Signature: ……..

Date: ……..

DEDICATION

I dedicate this teaching practicum I to my parents and family members for their support, encouragement, and prayers throughout my academic journey. I also dedicate this work to my lecturers and friends whose guidance and motivation have greatly contributed to my success.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I sincerely thank God for granting me the strength and good health to complete my teaching practicum. My gratitude goes to South Eastern Kenya University, school of education, for organizing the teaching practicum I programme. I also express my gratitude to the Teaching Practice Coordinator Professor Njue for his guidance and timely feedback during the practicum. I am also grateful to the Principal, Deputy Principal, teachers, support stuff, and students of Nyabimwa Mixed Secondary School for warmly welcoming me and providing a conducive environment for learning and professional growth making my practicum experience a success. Finally, I wish to thank my family and friends for their continuous encouragement, moral support, and understanding throughout the practicum period.

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1.0 INTRODUCTION

Teaching Practicum is an important component of teacher education that provides student teachers with an opportunity to apply the knowledge, skills, and attitudes acquired during their university training in an actual school setting

Teaching Practicum allows student teachers to gain hands-on experience in lesson planning, classroom management, learner assessment, and the use of appropriate teaching methods and instructional resources. It also provides an opportunity for student teachers to interact with learners, fellow teachers, school administrators, and other stakeholders in the education sector..

Furthermore, teaching practicum promotes reflective practice by enabling student teachers to evaluate their strengths and identify areas that require improvement. It therefore plays a significant role in preparing competent, confident, and professional teachers who are capable of meeting the diverse needs of learners in contemporary classrooms.

The primary purpose of Teaching Practicum I is to provide student teachers with practical teaching experience in a real school environment. It is designed to help them integrate theoretical knowledge gained during coursework with classroom practice.

Teaching Practicum I also aims to familiarize student teachers with the policies, culture, and administrative structures of schools. It exposes them to professional responsibilities such as preparing lesson plans, schemes of work, maintaining records of work, assessing learners, and participating in co-curricular activities.

In addition, teaching Practicum I provides an opportunity for student teachers to receive professional guidance and mentorship from experienced teachers and university supervisors. The objectives of Teaching Practicum include:

1. To enable student teachers to apply educational theories and teaching methods in actual classroom situations.
2. To develop effective classroom management and communication skills.
3. To enhance competence in lesson planning, preparation of instructional materials, and content delivery.
4. To develop appropriate learner assessment techniques and record-keeping skills.

5. To promote professionalism, ethical conduct, and responsibility in teaching.
6. To improve problem-solving and decision-making skills within the school environment.
7. To encourage reflective teaching practices for continuous professional improvement.
8. To prepare student teachers for future employment by exposing them to the expectations and responsibilities of the teaching profession.
9. To enable student teachers to appreciate individual learner differences and adopt appropriate teaching strategies to address them.
10. To develop confidence and positive attitudes towards teaching and lifelong professional learning.

Teaching Practicum I at South Eastern Kenya University (SEKU) is conducted for a period of thirty (30) working days as stipulated in the university practicum guidelinesThe thirty working days provide student teachers with sufficient time to familiarize themselves with the school environment and gain practical teaching experience.

Throughout this period, they are expected to know how to prepare professional documents such as schemes of work, lesson plans, records of work, and learner assessment records. Student teachers are also expected to demonstrate professionalism, ethical conduct, and effective classroom management skills while carrying out their teaching responsibilities.

Furthermore, the practicum period enables student teachers to receive guidance and constructive feedback from university supervisors, cooperating teachers, and school administrators. Such feedback plays a vital role in improving their instructional practices and professional competencies.

The practicum experience also promotes professionalism by instilling discipline, responsibility, and ethical conduct. Student teachers learn the importance of punctuality, proper documentation, teamwork, and adherence to school policies and regulations. Moreover, they develop positive working relationships with learners, colleagues, and school administrators.

Additionally, teaching practicum enhances creativity and innovation in instructional practices by encouraging student teachers to use learner-centred approaches and appropriate teaching

resources. It equips them with the skills necessary to create inclusive and supportive learning environments that cater for diverse learner needs.

Finally, teaching practicum serves as a foundation for lifelong professional development. The experiences gained during the practicum period prepare student teachers for successful careers in education and contribute significantly to the production of competent, reflective, and effective teachers capable of positively influencing learners and society.

2.0 PROFILE OF THE SCHOOL

Nyabimwa Mixed Secondary School is a mixed day secondary school located in Suneka Division, Kisii South Sub-County, KISII County, Kenya. The school has an approximate student population of 144.The school has fourteen (14) teachers comprising Teachers Service Commission (TSC) employed teachers and teachers employed by the Board of Management (BOM). In addition to the teaching staff, the school has support staff members who perform administrative, security, and maintenance duties that contribute significantly to the smooth running of the institution.

The school has various facilities that support effective teaching and learning. These include adequately furnished classrooms, a science laboratory for practical subjects, a library that provides learning resources , and water storage tanks that ensure a reliable supply of water for daily school activities. The school also has offices for the administration and staff members, sanitation facilities, and open spaces used for co-curricular activities.

The academic performance of Nyabimwa Mixed Secondary School has shown commendable progress over the years. The school continuously strives to improve learners' performance in both internal examinations and national assessments through effective teaching practices, remedial programmes, guidance and counselling services, and regular academic monitoring.

The school actively participates in various co-curricular activities that contribute to the holistic development of learners. These activities include games and sports, Seventh-day Adventist (SDA) fellowship, guidance and counselling programmes, music and drama activities, and environmental conservation initiatives. The organizational structure of the school is well organized to ensure effective leadership and administration. The school is headed by the Principal, who oversees all academic and administrative matters.

3.0 ACTIVITIES UNDERTAKEN DURING THE PRACTICUM

Upon reporting to Nyabimwa Mixed Secondary School, I was warmly received by the school administration and oriented on the school's policies, rules, regulations, and daily programmes. I was introduced to the members of staff and familiarized myself with the school timetable, organizational structure, and professional expectations. Throughout the practicum period, I attended morning assemblies on Mondays and Fridays where important academic and administrative matters were communicated to learners. I worked closely with other teachers in curriculum implementation and learner support activities. I assisted in preparing instructional materials, guiding learners during classroom activities, marking assignments and offering academic assistance whenever necessary.

Classroom observation formed an important part of my practicum experience. I observed experienced teachers as they delivered lessons using different teaching methods and classroom management techniques. I participated in guidance and counselling activities aimed at promoting learners' academic performance, discipline, and emotional well-being. During the practicum period, I actively participated in various co-curricular activities organized by the school. I served as a coach for the school's leg ball team where I guided learners during training sessions and encouraged teamwork, discipline, and sportsmanship

During the practicum, I was involved in maintaining professional teaching records and documents. These included lesson plans, schemes of work, records of work covered, learners' attendance records, and assessment records.

The practicum experience provided opportunities to interact with members of the school community including parents, teachers, learners, and support staff. Community engagement activities strengthened my appreciation of the collective responsibility of promoting quality education and learner welfare.

I was assigned teacher-on-duty responsibilities during my practicum period. My duties included supervising learners during assemblies, monitoring cleanliness within the school compound, maintaining discipline during break and lunch hours, and ensuring learners adhered to the school's rules and regulations. The activities undertaken during my Teaching Practicum I greatly contributed to my professional growth and development as a student teacher.

4.0 CLASSROOM OBSERVATION AND EXPERIENCES

During my Teaching Practicum I, I observed various classroom teaching and learning activities in Grade 10 Physics and Chemistry classes. The observations enabled me to appreciate how teachers implement the Competency Based Curriculum (CBC) in senior secondary schools through learner-centred approaches that actively engage learners in the learning process. I gained valuable experiences in classroom management, lesson preparation, assessment techniques, teacher-learner interaction, and the effective use of teaching and learning resources.

I observed that teachers employed effective classroom management strategies to create a conducive learning environment. Lessons began promptly, and learners were encouraged to settle down before the commencement of teaching activities. Teachers maintained discipline by establishing clear classroom expectations and ensuring that learners remained actively engaged throughout the lesson.

The teachers used positive reinforcement to motivate learners and maintained orderly classroom arrangements that promoted active participation. Group discussions were well coordinated, and teachers effectively managed time to ensure all lesson objectives were achieved. Learners were encouraged to ask questions freely, which promoted confidence and meaningful classroom interactions.

The teachers employed a variety of learner-centred teaching methods in line with CBC requirements. These included question-and-answer sessions, demonstrations, group discussions, guided discovery, brainstorming, and problem-solving approaches. During Physics lessons, teachers encouraged learners to explain scientific concepts and relate them to real-life situations. In Chemistry lessons, demonstrations and discussions were used to enhance learners' understanding of scientific principles.

The teachers effectively integrated collaborative learning by assigning learners group activities that promoted communication, critical thinking, and teamwork. The use of practical examples enhanced conceptual understanding and enabled learners to actively participate in constructing knowledge rather than merely receiving information from the teacher.

Learner participation was highly emphasized during classroom instruction. Teachers provided opportunities for learners to contribute ideas, ask questions, and participate in group discussions and presentations. Learners demonstrated enthusiasm during practical demonstrations and willingly shared their opinions during classroom interactions.

I observed that CBC promotes active learner participation through learner-centred methodologies. Rather than being passive recipients of information, learners actively engaged in inquiry-based activities that enhanced their understanding and problem-solving abilities. This approach significantly contributed to meaningful learning experiences among students.

Teachers effectively utilized various teaching and learning resources to facilitate instruction. These included textbooks, charts, laboratory apparatus, chalkboards, and locally available instructional materials. During Physics lessons, practical demonstrations enabled learners to visualize abstract scientific concepts, while Chemistry lessons incorporated laboratory resources to enhance conceptual understanding.

The use of teaching and learning materials significantly improved learner engagement and retention of concepts. Teachers carefully selected instructional resources that aligned with lesson objectives and learners' needs. I observed that appropriate utilization of resources contributes positively towards successful curriculum implementation under CBC.

Positive teacher-student relationships were evident throughout classroom instruction. Teachers maintained professional interactions with learners by encouraging participation and responding respectfully to learners' questions and contributions. Constructive feedback was provided whenever learners encountered difficulties in understanding concepts.

Teachers adopted inclusive teaching approaches by recognizing individual learner differences and providing appropriate support whenever necessary. Learners freely interacted with their teachers without fear, thereby creating a supportive learning environment that enhanced both academic performance and personal development.

I observed that teachers adequately prepared for their lessons by developing professional documents such as lesson plans, schemes of work, records of work covered, and assessment

records. Lesson objectives were clearly stated and aligned with the competencies outlined in the CBC curriculum designs.

The teachers organized their lessons systematically by introducing concepts progressively and employing suitable instructional strategies to facilitate understanding. Effective lesson preparation contributed significantly towards successful content delivery and learner achievement. The observations strengthened my appreciation of the importance of proper planning in effective teaching and learning processes.

Teachers employed both formative and summative assessment techniques to monitor learners' progress. These included oral questioning, assignments, class exercises, practical activities, group presentations, and written tests. Immediate feedback was provided to learners to facilitate continuous improvement and reinforce understanding of concepts taught.

CBC implementation places considerable emphasis on continuous assessment and competency acquisition. I observed that assessment activities were integrated into classroom instruction to evaluate not only content mastery but also the development of communication, collaboration, critical thinking, and problem-solving competencies among learners.

Through my classroom observations, I gained a deeper understanding of how the Competency Based Curriculum is implemented in secondary school education. I observed that teachers play the role of facilitators of learning by creating opportunities for learners to actively construct knowledge through participation and collaboration.

CBC implementation promotes the acquisition of competencies, values, and practical skills alongside academic content. I learned that effective implementation requires adequate lesson preparation, appropriate instructional resources, continuous learner assessment, and positive teacher-learner relationships. The observations further enhanced my professional competencies and prepared me for future classroom practice as a teacher.

Classroom observation provided invaluable professional experiences throughout my practicum period. It enhanced my understanding of classroom management practices, learner-centred teaching methodologies, CBC implementation strategies, assessment techniques, and effective teacher-learner interactions. The experiences gained have significantly contributed to my

professional growth and strengthened my preparedness for future responsibilities as a competent and reflective teacher.

5.0 CHALLENGES ENCOUNTERED

During my Teaching Practicum I, I encountered several challenges that affected various aspects of teaching and learning. Although the practicum experience was highly beneficial and enriching, these challenges provided valuable opportunities for professional growth and enhanced my problem-solving abilities as a student teacher.

One of the challenges encountered during the practicum period was the inadequacy of some teaching and learning resources. The implementation of the Competency Based Curriculum (CBC) requires the use of diverse instructional materials, practical activities, and learner-centred approaches. However, the limited availability of some teaching resources occasionally affected the effective delivery of lessons, particularly in science subjects that require practical demonstrations and experiments. Consequently, teachers were sometimes required to improvise or adopt alternative instructional strategies to achieve lesson objectives.

Effective time management was another challenge experienced during the practicum period. Balancing lesson preparation, classroom instruction, record keeping, co-curricular activities, duty responsibilities, and participation in school programmes required proper planning and organization. At times, the available lesson time was insufficient to adequately conduct learner-centred activities, discussions, and assessments as required by CBC implementation. This necessitated careful prioritization of learning activities to ensure lesson objectives were achieved within the allocated time.

Unlike schools with large class sizes, Nyabimwa Mixed Secondary School has a relatively small student population. While this provides teachers with opportunities to offer individualized attention to learners, it also presents challenges during the implementation of collaborative learning strategies recommended under CBC. Group discussions and project-based activities are sometimes less effective when learner numbers are limited, making it difficult to organize diverse and meaningful group interactions. Consequently, teachers are often required to modify instructional strategies to suit the available class sizes while ensuring active learner participation.

Although discipline levels were generally satisfactory, occasional learner discipline challenges were experienced during the practicum period. Some learners occasionally exhibited low levels of participation, lateness in completing assignments, and inadequate preparedness for classroom

activities. Such challenges affected the pace of lesson delivery and required additional time for guidance and counselling interventions.

The school also experienced limitations relating to infrastructure and facilities. The Competency Based Curriculum emphasizes practical and learner-centred instructional approaches that require adequate learning spaces and resources. Limited facilities occasionally affected the organization of practical activities and learner engagement programmes. Continuous investment in educational infrastructure would significantly contribute towards improving curriculum implementation and enhancing learning experiences.

Another challenge encountered during the practicum period was the limited number of classrooms designated for optional subjects such as Chemistry in Grade 10. With the implementation of the Competency Based Curriculum (CBC), learners are enrolled in different pathways and subject combinations that require adequate learning spaces. However, the available classrooms were sometimes insufficient to comfortably accommodate the organization and delivery of lessons for optional subjects.

Additionally, the challenge occasionally limited opportunities for conducting practical demonstrations and group-based learning activities that are essential in science subjects such as Chemistry and Physics. Despite these limitations, teachers demonstrated creativity and professionalism in maximizing the available resources to facilitate effective teaching and learning.

This experience enabled me to appreciate the importance of adequate educational infrastructure in supporting successful CBC implementation and promoting meaningful learner experiences.

6.0 LESSONS LEARNED AND SKILLS ACQUIRED

Communication Skills

Throughout the practicum period, I developed effective communication skills through my daily interactions with learners, teachers, and members of the school administration. I learned how to communicate instructions clearly and appropriately while maintaining professionalism and respect. Through classroom observations and participation in school activities, I appreciated the importance of active listening and providing constructive feedback to learners. These experiences have enhanced my confidence in communicating effectively within educational environments.

Classroom Management Skills

The practicum experience greatly improved my classroom management skills. I learned how teachers create conducive learning environments by maintaining discipline, promoting learner participation, and effectively managing classroom activities. Through observation and participation in teaching and co-curricular activities, I acquired skills in learner supervision, classroom organization, and behaviour management. Serving as a teacher on duty further strengthened my ability to supervise learners and maintain discipline within the school environment.

Teamwork and Collaboration

Teaching Practicum enabled me to appreciate the importance of teamwork and collaboration in educational institutions. I worked closely with teachers, learners, and members of the school administration in implementing various school programmes and activities. Participation in co-curricular activities and departmental responsibilities enhanced my ability to work effectively with others towards achieving common educational objectives. I learned that collaboration among educational stakeholders significantly contributes to successful curriculum implementation and learner achievement.

Leadership Skills

My leadership skills were strengthened during the practicum period through participation in various school responsibilities. Serving as a teacher on duty and coaching learners during co-curricular activities enabled me to develop decision-making, organizational, and supervisory competencies. I learned how effective leadership contributes towards maintaining discipline, promoting learner welfare, and creating supportive learning environments. These experiences have enhanced my confidence and preparedness for future leadership responsibilities within educational institutions.

Professional Ethics

The practicum period enabled me to develop a deeper understanding of professional ethics expected of teachers. I learned the importance of punctuality, integrity, accountability, confidentiality, and professional conduct while interacting with learners and colleagues. Adhering to school policies and maintaining professionalism throughout the practicum experience enhanced my appreciation of ethical practices within the teaching profession. I have also learned that professional ethics significantly contribute towards creating positive teacher-learner relationships and promoting institutional excellence.

Problem-Solving Skills

Teaching Practicum exposed me to various challenges that required flexibility and creativity in addressing educational needs. Limited teaching resources, time management difficulties, and infrastructure challenges required teachers to adopt appropriate strategies that facilitated effective teaching and learning. Through these experiences, I developed problem-solving skills that enabled me to appreciate the importance of adaptability and innovation within educational settings.

Observation and Analytical Skills

Classroom observations significantly enhanced my observation and analytical skills. By observing Grade 10 Physics and Chemistry lessons, I gained valuable insights into how teachers effectively implement the Competency Based Curriculum using learner-centred teaching methodologies. I learned how to critically analyze classroom practices, teaching strategies,

assessment methods, and learner participation patterns. These experiences have strengthened my ability to reflect on instructional practices and continuously improve my professional competencies.

Time Management Skills

The practicum experience enhanced my ability to effectively manage time while balancing multiple responsibilities. Lesson preparation, participation in assemblies, co-curricular activities, classroom observations, and teacher-on-duty responsibilities required careful planning and organization. I learned how effective time management contributes significantly to successful curriculum implementation and professional performance. The experience has prepared me to effectively prioritize responsibilities while maintaining high standards of professionalism and productivity.

8.0 RECOMMENDATIONS

The Teaching Practicum I experience was highly beneficial and contributed significantly to my professional growth as a student teacher. However, there are several areas that can be improved to enhance the effectiveness of future practicum programmes and support successful implementation of the Competency Based Curriculum (CBC). The following recommendations are directed to relevant stakeholders.

Recommendations to the University

South Eastern Kenya University should continue strengthening the Teaching Practicum programme by providing adequate orientation to student teachers before placement. The university should also enhance supervision processes to ensure timely and constructive feedback that supports the professional development of student teachers. Additionally, organizing seminars and workshops on CBC implementation before practicum would adequately prepare student teachers for contemporary classroom practices.

Recommendations to the School Administration

The school administration should continue supporting student teachers by creating conducive learning environments that promote professional growth and effective curriculum implementation. There is also a need to improve teaching and learning facilities, particularly classroom spaces for optional subjects such as Chemistry and Physics under CBC. Adequate instructional resources should be provided to facilitate practical and learner-centred approaches recommended by the curriculum.

Recommendations to Student Teachers

Student teachers should maintain professionalism, punctuality, and commitment throughout the practicum period. They should actively seek guidance from cooperating teachers and continuously reflect on their teaching practices to improve their competencies. Additionally, they should embrace teamwork, creativity, and adaptability when addressing challenges encountered during curriculum implementation.

Recommendations to the Ministry of Education

The Ministry of Education should continue supporting schools in the implementation of CBC by providing adequate teaching and learning resources and improving educational infrastructure. More investment is required in science laboratories, classrooms, and instructional materials to facilitate competency-based learning. The Ministry should also provide continuous professional development programmes that equip teachers with emerging pedagogical skills required for effective curriculum implementation.

Recommendations for Future Practicum Programmes

Future Teaching Practicum programmes should provide student teachers with adequate opportunities to participate in both classroom instruction and co-curricular activities. Enhanced collaboration among universities, schools, and education stakeholders will contribute significantly towards improving practicum experiences. Furthermore, sufficient time should be allocated for classroom observations and professional mentorship to enable student teachers to acquire practical competencies required in the teaching profession.

The implementation of these recommendations will significantly enhance the quality and effectiveness of Teaching Practicum programmes while promoting successful curriculum implementation in schools. Collaborative efforts among universities, schools, student teachers, and educational stakeholders will contribute towards producing competent, reflective, and professional educators capable of addressing contemporary educational needs.

9.0 CONCLUSION

Teaching Practicum I was an enriching and transformative learning experience that significantly contributed to my personal and professional development as a student teacher. The practicum provided me with an opportunity to bridge the gap between theoretical knowledge acquired at the university and its practical application within the school environment. Through active participation in teaching and learning activities, classroom observations, co-curricular programmes, and school administration responsibilities, I gained valuable experiences that have strengthened my competence and confidence as a future educator.

The practicum experience enabled me to appreciate the important role teachers play in nurturing learners academically, socially, and morally. I observed how the Competency Based Curriculum (CBC) is implemented in Grade 10 Physics and Chemistry classes using learner-centred teaching approaches that promote competency acquisition, critical thinking, collaboration, and problem-solving skills among learners.

Furthermore, Teaching Practicum I significantly contributed to my personal growth by enhancing my communication, leadership, classroom management, teamwork, problem-solving, and time management skills. Through my responsibilities as a teacher on duty, participation in co-curricular activities as a coach, and engagement in guidance and counselling programmes, I developed valuable professional competencies that will positively influence my future teaching career.

The practicum has adequately prepared me for future teaching practice by exposing me to the realities, expectations, and responsibilities of the teaching profession. It has enhanced my confidence in interacting with learners and educational stakeholders while reinforcing the importance of professionalism, ethical conduct, and lifelong learning.

In conclusion, Teaching Practicum I was a rewarding and invaluable experience that has laid a strong foundation for my future career as a professional teacher.

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